The Allies captured the railway leading to Myitkyina on March 10, 1944. In late April 1944, the Chinese launched an attack from Yunnan. Japanese forces in Upper Burma were easily defeated. The Allied offensive against Myitkyina began on May 17, 1944, when airborne glider troops under British General Orde Wingate landed behind Japanese lines at Myitkyina airfield. The Allies were able to take airfield with relative ease, but were unable advance further because of stiff Japanese resistance. On June 3, 1944, the 42nd and 150th Chinese Regiments attacked Myitkyina and suffered heavy casualties. Over the next month, a battle of attrition combined with exhaustion and disease claimed a significant number of casualties on both sides. The Japanese garrison held out until early August. After seeing the main part of his army safely withdraw, General Mizukami committed suicide. This allowed other Japanese troops time to prepare a defensive line further south. On August 4, 1944, Myitkyina was finally captured. The capture of Myitkyina allowed the Allies the use of key airfields.

After the Allies had regrouped after the capture of Myitkyina, they pushed south again. At this stage of the Burma campaign Japanese strategy changed to a defensive posture in hopes of holding on to southern Burma, abandoning their plan of maintaining a northern flank to threaten the allied supply line to China.

THE END OF JAPANESE OCCUPATION

The battle of Myitkyina marked the beginning of the end for the Japanese suzerainty over Burma. The Allies continued their campaign in Burma in late 1944 and early 1945. In Arakan, the XV Corp launched an assault on Akyab Island. Unable to halt the Allied advance the Japanese retreated from Akyab Island on December 31, 1944. The XV Corp then launched an amphibious assault on the Myebon Peninsula on January 12, 1945; 10 days later, the Allies cut off the retreating Japanese. Fighting lasted until the end of January when the heavy casualties suffered by the Japanese limited their ability to put up an adequate fight. The XV Corp went on to capture Ramree Island and Cheduba Island, giving the Allies control over southern Burma. In Upper Burma, the 14th Army, consisting of the IV Corp and the XXXIII Corp, led the main assault. The IV Corp mission was to cross the Ayeyarwaddy River at Pakokku and seize the Japanese communication